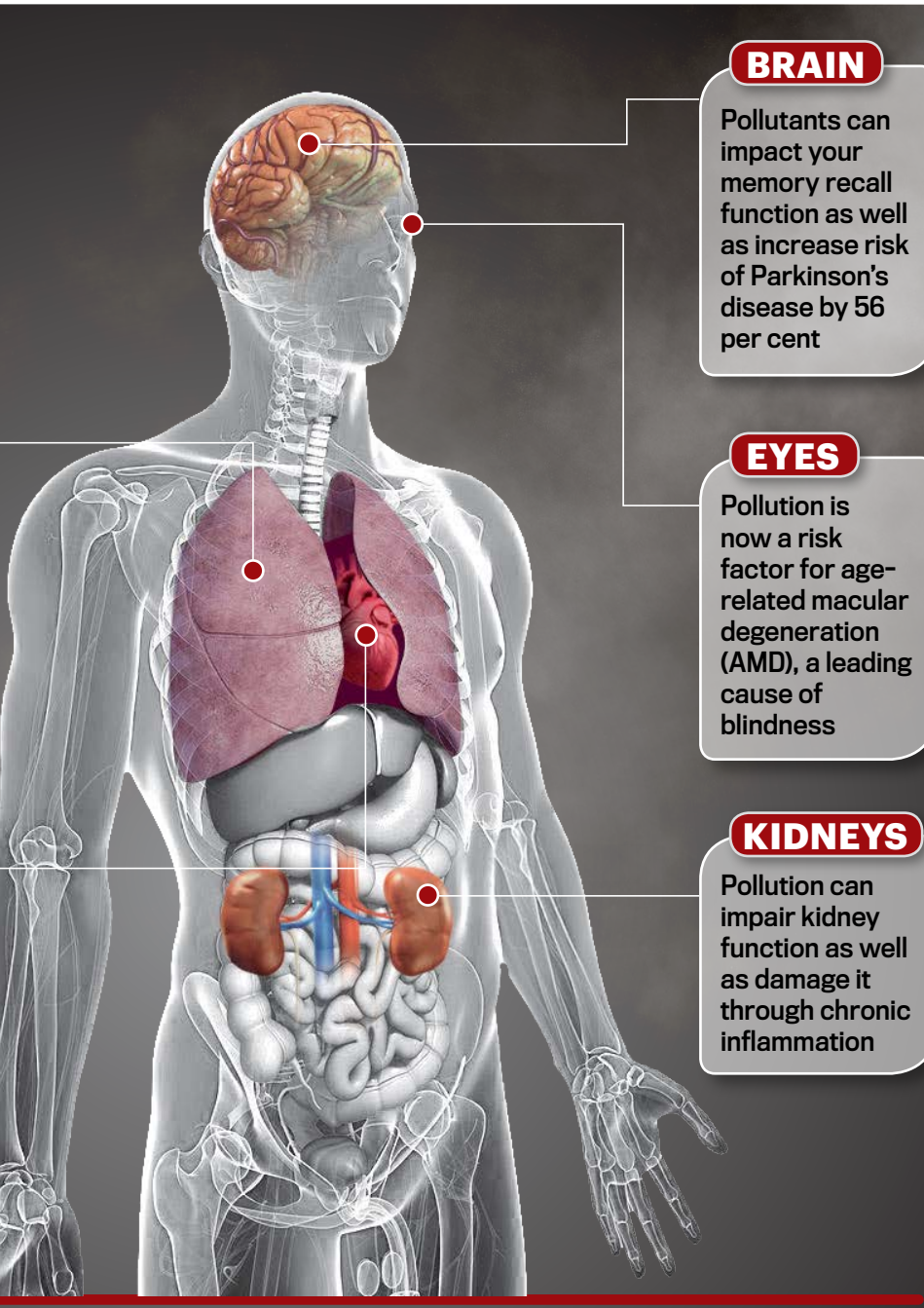


BRAIN

Pollutants can impact your memory recall function as well as increase risk of Parkinson's disease by 56 per cent

EYES

Pollution is now a risk factor for age-related macular degeneration (AMD), a leading cause of blindness

KIDNEYS

Pollution can impair kidney function as well as damage it through chronic inflammation





Vulnerable people—those above 60, below five, or with comorbidities like heart disease or respiratory disease—should remain indoors with as little exposure to outside air as possible



If you have trouble breathing, contact a doctor immediately

DISEASES BEING STRONGLY LINKED TO POLLUTION FOR THE FIRST TIME

METABOLIC DISORDERS

Per a study, the risk for diabetes increased by 22 per cent for every 10 micrograms per cubic meter (µg/m3) increase in annual average levels of PM2.5 in Delhi and Chennai

CANCERS

Inflammation caused by pollutants wakes up normally inactive cells in organs that carry cancer-causing mutations. For every 10 µg/m3 of increased exposure to PM2.5, risk of dying from any cancer rose by 22 per cent. For cancers of the upper digestive tract, the mortality risk was 42 per cent higher. For cancers of the accessory digestive organs like the liver, bile ducts, gall bladder and the pancreas, the mortality risk was 35 per cent higher. For breast cancer, the mortality risk went up by 80 per cent

REDUCED BRAIN PERFORMANCE

A rise in exposure to air toxins has been linked to reduced academic performance in school; for some, the effect is equivalent to missing out a whole month of elementary schooling